

ISTQB FOUNDATION MASTERCLASS

Summary Posters

One-page visual summaries of each syllabus chapter for the wall above your desk.

Poster 1 — Fundamentals of Testing

The seven principles at a glance, plus the core vocabulary.

- Testing shows presence of defects, not their absence
- Exhaustive testing is impossible
- Early testing saves time and money
- Defects cluster together
- Beware the pesticide paradox — vary your tests
- Testing is context dependent
- Absence-of-errors is a fallacy

Term	One-line meaning
Error	A human mistake
Defect	The resulting flaw in the work product
Failure	The wrong behaviour when the defect is executed

Poster 2 — Testing Throughout the SDLC

- Test levels: Component, Integration, System, Acceptance
- Test types: Functional, Non-functional, White-box, Change-related
- Confirmation testing re-checks a fix; Regression testing guards against side effects
- Maintenance testing follows changes, migrations and retirements

Level	Who / focus
Component	Developers — units in isolation
Integration	Interfaces and interactions between components/systems
System	End-to-end behaviour of the whole system

Level	Who / focus
Acceptance	Validation against user needs (UAT, alpha, beta)

Poster 3 — Static Testing

- Static testing examines work products without executing code
- Finds defects early, when they are cheapest to fix
- Review roles: Manager, Author, Moderator, Scribe, Reviewer, Leader

Review type	Formality
Informal review	Lowest — cheap, quick feedback
Walkthrough	Led by the author
Technical review	Led by trained reviewers/peers
Inspection	Highest — formal, metrics-driven

Poster 4 — Test Techniques

Category	Techniques
Black-box	Equivalence partitioning, boundary value analysis, decision tables, state transition
White-box	Statement coverage, branch coverage
Experience-based	Error guessing, exploratory testing, checklist-based

- Black-box derives tests from behaviour/specifications
- White-box derives tests from internal structure/code
- Experience-based leans on tester knowledge and intuition

Poster 5 — Managing the Test Activities

- Test plan: scope, approach, resources, schedule, entry/exit criteria, risks
- Risk-based testing prioritises by likelihood x impact
- Product risk = product may fail stakeholders; Project risk = project management risk
- Defect report: ID, summary, steps, expected vs actual, severity, priority, status

Concept	Quick contrast
Entry vs exit criteria	Ready to start vs done
Severity vs priority	Impact on system vs urgency to fix
Verification vs validation	Build it right vs build the right thing

Poster 6 — Test Tools

- Tools support activities across the whole test process
- Benefits: repeatable, fast regression; consistent, objective execution
- Risks: underestimated maintenance cost, over-reliance, unrealistic expectations

BEST PRACTICE

Print one poster per chapter and put them where you actually sit. Passive, repeated exposure to the same tight summaries builds recall with almost no effort.